



December 2006 amendment to the law was primarily intended to take land and distribute it in a way that serves the interests of the people. "Our main aim is not to prosecute anyone, though penal provisions could be invoked against those who don't come forward to surrender the assigned land," says Rao.

Significantly, the Congress Government has already, in the last three years, distributed 4.37 lakh acre in three phases, of which 1.55 lakh acre of land was redistributed on January 26, 2005. While the Government points

**RED SIGNAL: CPI(M) cadres hold rallies demanding their assigned land** out that its redistribution and reforms plans are on track, the rival Communists are pushing ahead for forcible occupation by encouraging supporters to snatch land, braving police batons. "Our struggle won't stop till every poor family gets agricultural land and house sites," says state Secretary B.V. Raghavulu. The Left parties, the original authors of land reforms in Kerala, believe such measures are their prerogative and won't brook the

## FOR A PIECE OF LAND

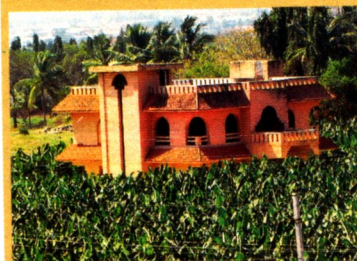
■ Over 3 lakh people violated the law to acquire more than 4 lakh acre of assigned land till June-end

■ Most violations in the districts of Warangal (55,975 acre by 60,355 persons), Prakasam (35,769 acre by 19,159 persons), Nizamabad (30,130 acre by 25,426 persons), Ranga Reddy (9,690 acre by 4,395 persons)

■ Only 1,936 persons have surrendered 4,350 acre voluntarily

■ 2,14,541 notices issued for the recovery of 2,94,176 acre

■ 6,462 acre has been restored to 6,714 original assignees; 10,452 acre has been taken back and assigned to other landless poor; 10,620 acre is being used for public purpose in 4,022 cases



**INVASION: JJ Grape Gardens of Jayalalithaa stands on illegal land**

Congress or any other party, stealing their thunder. It is the contention of the Left that the amendment of the 1977 Act and the guidelines, if enforced, will ensure that those illegally occupying land will become the legal owners.

The CPI(M) alleges that the state Government is acquiring 866.67 acre of the total 1,048 acre of such land for a proposed Jindal factory in Vizianagaram district. Rao admits to the acquisitions, but says due compensation has been paid for it. The CPI(M) aren't impressed, predictably, smell a rat. ■



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